Houston Texans Offense: Scouting Report

Public data. Built from nflverse (nflfastR play-by-play, NGS participation, FTN charting), mapped onto the PFF GamePBP layout. Run concepts, PFF success codes, yards after contact and receiver alignment are not in this source; see *What nflverse cannot cover* at the end.

Sample: 19 games (Sep 07, 2025 to Jan 18, 2026) · 1191 offensive plays · Opponents: ARZ, BLT, BUF, DEN, IND, JAX, KC, LA, LAC, LV, NE, PIT, SEA, SF, TB, TEN
Source: HST_2025_nflverse_GamePBP.csv · Generated Nov 05, 2026 16:44 · Success = standard yardage definition · EPA = nflfastR model

61%	53%	-0.03	45%	40%
PASS RATE	NEUTRAL EARLY-DOWN PASS RATE	EPA / PLAY	SUCCESS RATE	3RD-DOWN CONVERSION

5%	7%
SACK RATE	EXPLOSIVE PLAY RATE

Key findings

TENDENCIES

- Passes on 61% of all plays and 53% of neutral early-down plays (1st/2nd down, outside 2-minute drills).
- QB alignment is a strong run/pass key: under center they run 69% of the time (n=452); in shotgun they pass 79% (n=739).
- Base personnel is 11 (67% of snaps, 74% pass). 8 groupings reach 10+ plays.
- Tell: 3rd Down + Long (7-10) → pass 99% of the time (n=70, 95% lower bound 92%).
- Tell: Shotgun + 3rd Down → pass 92% of the time (n=223, 95% lower bound 88%).
- Tell: 11 + 3rd Down → pass 90% of the time (n=227, 95% lower bound 85%).
- Tell: 21 (*) → run 100% of the time (n=22, 95% lower bound 85%).
- Run game is built on Middle and Right Guard: 48% of carries.
- Predictability: knowing personnel, alignment, down and distance lifts a defense's run/pass guess from 61% to 76% (leave-one-out).

STRENGTHS

- Most efficient run gap: Right Guard, +0.08 EPA/carry, 4.7 YPC, 53% success (n=89).
- Primary target: N. Collins (#12) (WR), 20% target share, 73 catches for 1134 yards, +0.29 EPA/target, 50 first downs.
- Most efficient receiver: D. Schultz (#86) (TE), +0.40 EPA/target on 111 targets, aDOT 6.1, 4.6 YAC/rec.
- Lead back W. Marks (#27): 49% of carries, 3.6 YPC, 47% success. Favorite gap: Middle.
- Most total value: D. Schultz (#86), 44.0 total EPA on 111 touches + targets (836 scrimmage yards).
- Play action: 22% of dropbacks, +0.04 EPA/play vs +0.03 without (n=162 vs 562).
- Deep shots (20+ air yards): 11% of targets, 36% complete, +0.39 EPA/target (n=69).

VULNERABILITIES

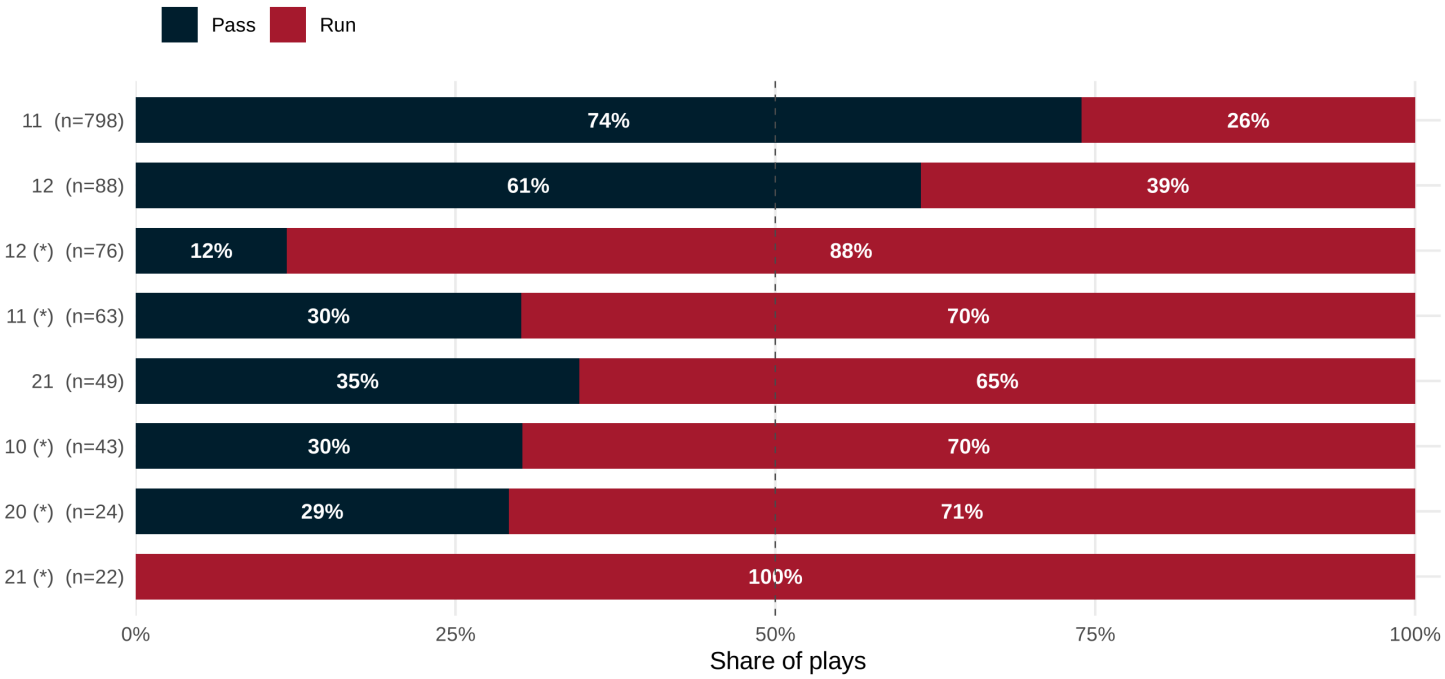
- Pressure breaks the passing game: -0.50 EPA/dropback when pressured vs +0.24 clean. Pressured on 28% of dropbacks; sack rate 5%.
- Least efficient run gap: Right Tackle, -0.33 EPA/carry, stuffed (0 or fewer yards) on 25% (n=65).
- On 3rd and Extra Long (11+) they convert only 18% (n=51); they pass 86% of the time there. Overall 3rd-down conversion: 40%.
- Least productive personnel: 21 (*), -0.37 EPA/play (n=22, 0% pass).
- High-volume, low-return target: C. Kirk (#13) (WR), 11% of targets but -0.14 EPA/target and 57% catch rate.

n = the number of plays (or carries / targets) behind a number, i.e. the sample size. Findings are generated by fixed rules (see Methodology) and include sample sizes. Treat any rate built on fewer than 10 plays as anecdotal.

1. Personnel run/pass tendencies

Run/pass split by personnel

Groupings with at least 10 plays. n = number of plays in that grouping



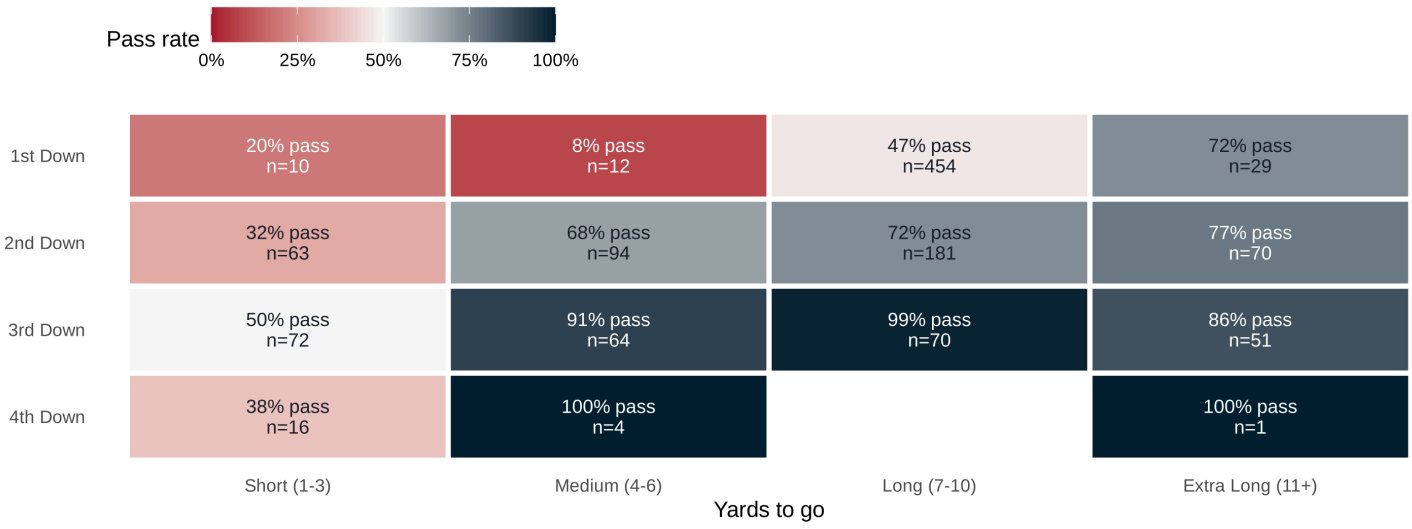
Data: nflverse (nflfastR pbp, NGS participation, FTN charting)

Personnel	Plays	Snap %	Pass %	Pass % 95% CI	Run EPA	Pass EPA	Success
11	798	67%	74%	71%-77%	-0.14	+0.08	46%
12	88	7%	61%	51%-71%	-0.14	-0.46	36%
12 (*)	76	6%	12%	6%-21%	+0.05	-0.08	58%
11 (*)	63	5%	30%	20%-42%	-0.03	-0.03	46%
21	49	4%	35%	23%-49%	-0.16	-0.13	33%
10 (*)	43	4%	30%	19%-45%	+0.03	+0.44	56%
20 (*)	24	2%	29%	15%-49%	-0.35	-0.29	33%
21 (*)	22	2%	0%	0%-15%	-0.37	n/a	36%
13	9	1%	89%	56%-98%	+1.04	-0.35	56%
22	8	1%	50%	22%-78%	+0.23	-0.11	38%
20	6	1%	17%	3%-56%	-0.17	+2.77	50%
22 (*)	3	0%	0%	0%-56%	-0.55	n/a	0%
01	1	0%	100%	21%-100%	n/a	-0.59	0%
13 (*)	1	0%	100%	21%-100%	n/a	+0.55	100%

2. Down-and-distance tendencies

Pass rate by down and distance

Each box: share of plays that were passes, and n = number of plays in that down-and-distance situation



Data: nflverse (nflfastR pbp, NGS participation, FTN charting)

Down	To go	Plays	Pass %	Run EPA	Pass EPA	Success
1st Down	Short (1-3)	10	20%	-0.36	+0.04	30%
1st Down	Medium (4-6)	12	8%	-0.19	-0.42	25%
1st Down	Long (7-10)	454	47%	-0.14	+0.06	49%
1st Down	Extra Long (11+)	29	72%	-0.02	-0.07	28%
2nd Down	Short (1-3)	63	32%	-0.09	+0.29	68%
2nd Down	Medium (4-6)	94	68%	+0.02	+0.03	52%
2nd Down	Long (7-10)	181	72%	-0.14	+0.09	43%
2nd Down	Extra Long (11+)	70	77%	-0.23	-0.13	21%
3rd Down	Short (1-3)	72	50%	-0.17	+0.38	65%
3rd Down	Medium (4-6)	64	91%	+0.50	-0.21	42%
3rd Down	Long (7-10)	70	99%	-0.26	+0.01	27%
3rd Down	Extra Long (11+)	51	86%	-0.47	+0.11	18%
4th Down	Short (1-3)	16	38%	+0.82	-0.59	69%
4th Down	Medium (4-6)	4	100%	n/a	-0.81	25%
4th Down	Extra Long (11+)	1	100%	n/a	-2.14	0%

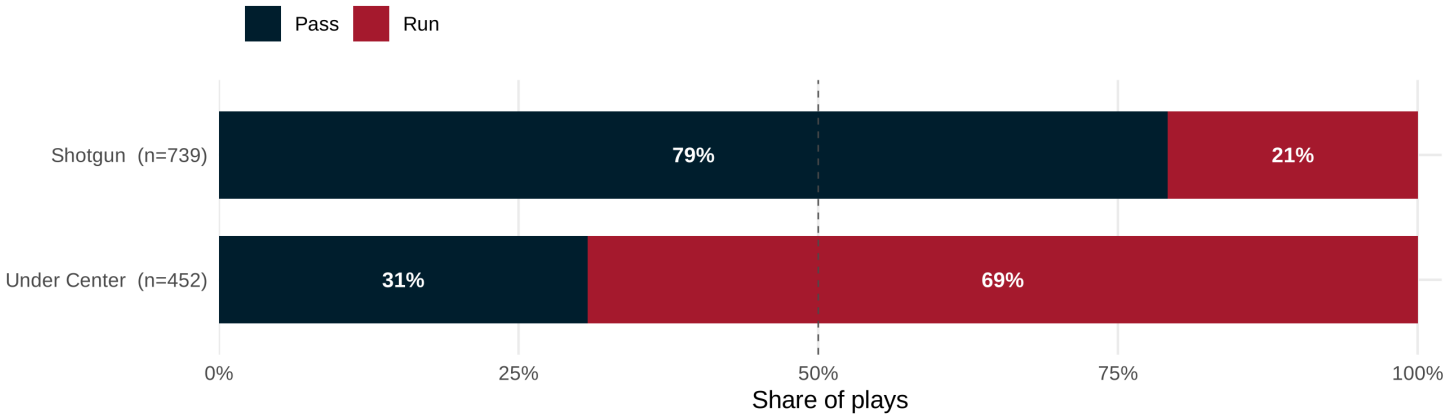
By field position (yards from the opponent's end zone):

Zone	Plays	Pass %	EPA/play	Success
Goal to Go (1-10)	80	55%	+0.01	41%
Red Zone (11-20)	96	55%	-0.20	36%
Plus Territory (21-50)	393	59%	+0.01	50%
Own Territory (51-80)	516	64%	-0.03	45%
Backed Up (81-99)	106	63%	-0.02	37%

3. QB alignment tendencies

Run/pass split by QB alignment

n = number of plays from that alignment; read small groups with caution



Data: nflverse (nflfastR pbp, NGS participation, FTN charting)

Alignment	Plays	Snap %	Pass %	Run EPA	Pass EPA	Run YPC	Pass Y/P
Under Center	452	38%	31%	-0.12	+0.06	3.2	6.8
Shotgun	739	62%	79%	-0.09	+0.02	5.0	5.9

Alignment by personnel (groupings with enough plays):

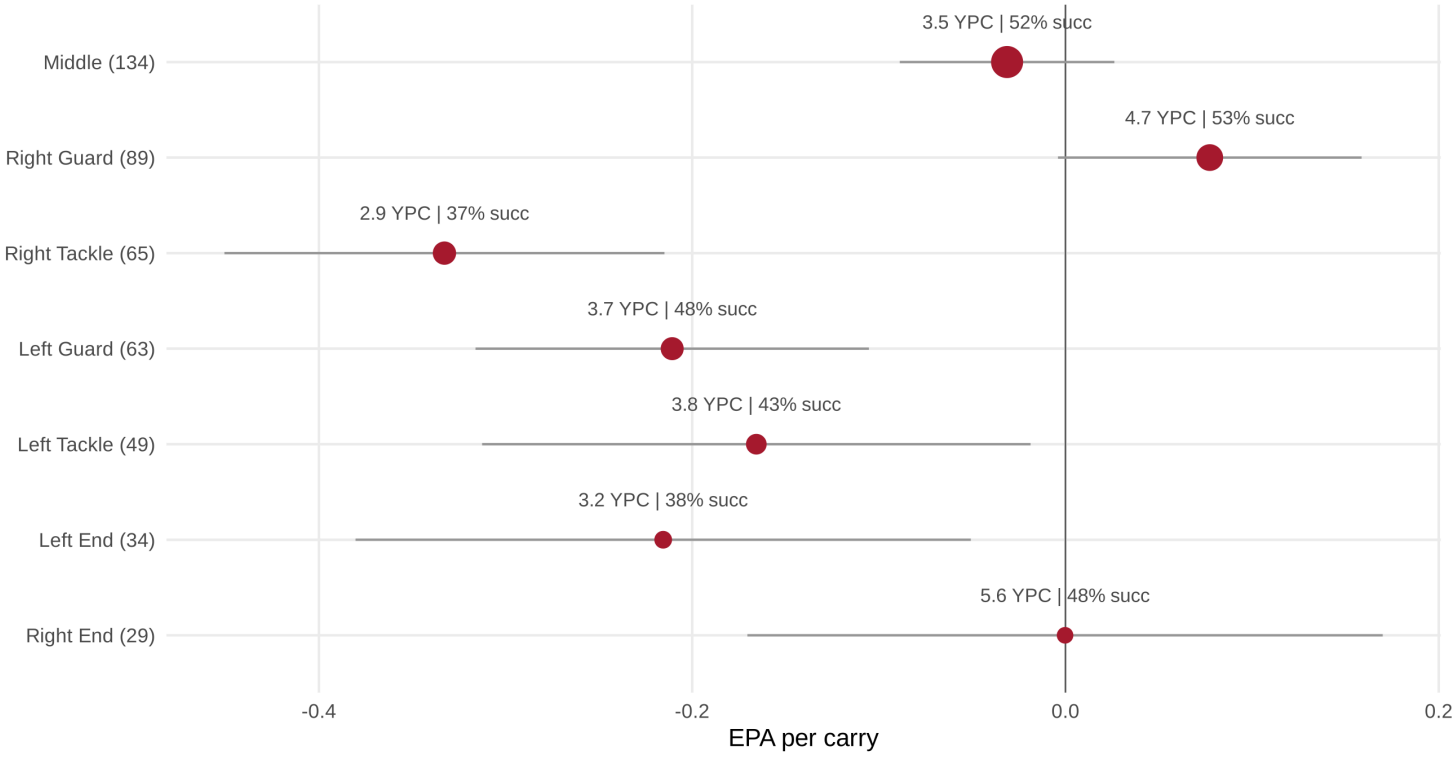
Personnel	Alignment	Plays	Pass %	EPA/play
10 (*)	Under Center	25	36%	+0.06
10 (*)	Shotgun	18	22%	+0.28
11	Under Center	137	29%	+0.10
11	Shotgun	661	83%	+0.00
11 (*)	Under Center	51	31%	+0.03
11 (*)	Shotgun	12	25%	-0.31
12	Under Center	59	61%	-0.39
12	Shotgun	29	62%	-0.24
12 (*)	Under Center	72	12%	+0.03
13	Under Center	5	80%	+0.33
20 (*)	Under Center	24	29%	-0.33
21	Under Center	43	30%	-0.20
21	Shotgun	6	67%	+0.21
21 (*)	Under Center	22	0%	-0.37
22	Under Center	8	50%	+0.06

4. Run gap and direction: frequency and effectiveness

nflverse does not chart blocking schemes, so runs are grouped by the gap and side the play-by-play records (end / tackle / guard / middle). This answers *where* they run, not *which concept*.

Run gap and direction: volume and efficiency

Ordered by carries (in brackets). Point = EPA per carry, bar = +/- 1 standard error



Data: nflverse (nflfastR pbp, NGS participation, FTN charting)

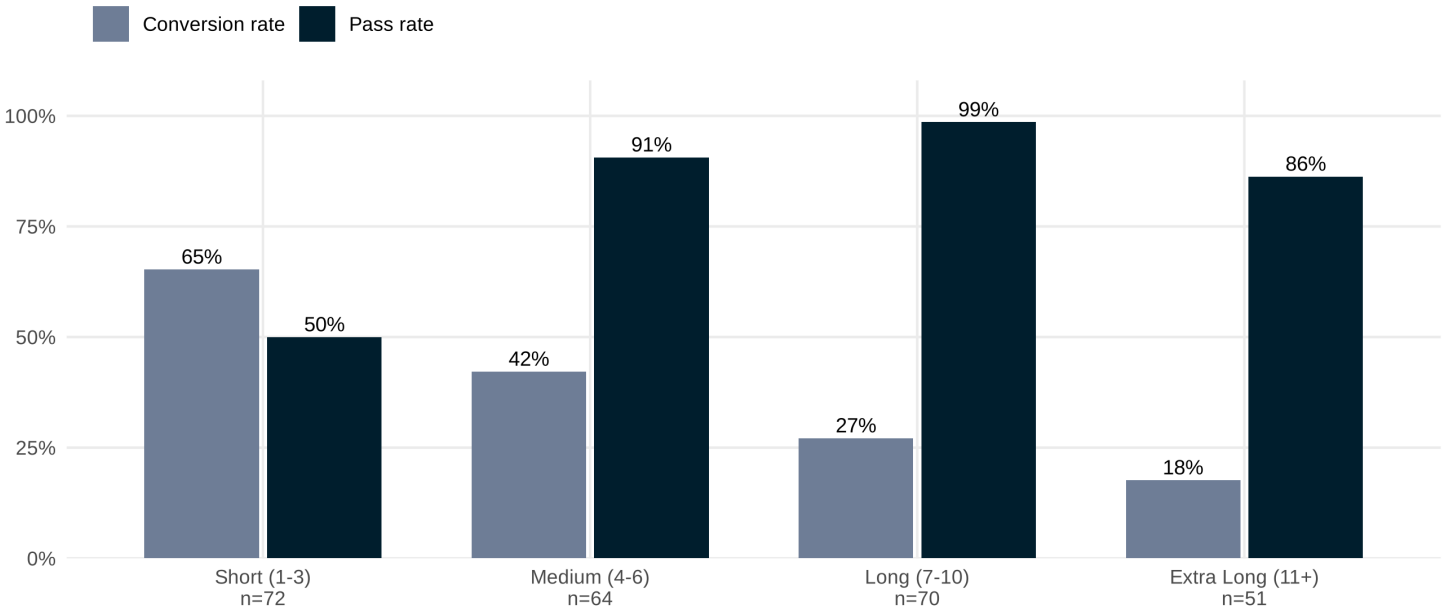
Concept	Carries	Share	YPC	Median	Success	EPA/carry	Stuff %	Explosive %	Under center %	Top personnel
Middle	134	29%	3.5	3.0	52%	-0.03	18%	4%	67%	11
Right Guard	89	19%	4.7	3.0	53%	+0.08	12%	9%	69%	11
Right Tackle	65	14%	2.9	3.0	37%	-0.33	25%	5%	72%	11
Left Guard	63	13%	3.7	2.0	48%	-0.21	30%	11%	60%	11
Left Tackle	49	10%	3.8	2.0	43%	-0.17	18%	8%	67%	11
Left End	34	7%	3.2	2.0	38%	-0.22	29%	9%	62%	11
Right End	29	6%	5.6	3.0	48%	-0.00	14%	14%	76%	11

4 carries with no charted run gap are left out of this table.

5. Third-down behavior and key targets

Third down: how often they throw and how often they convert

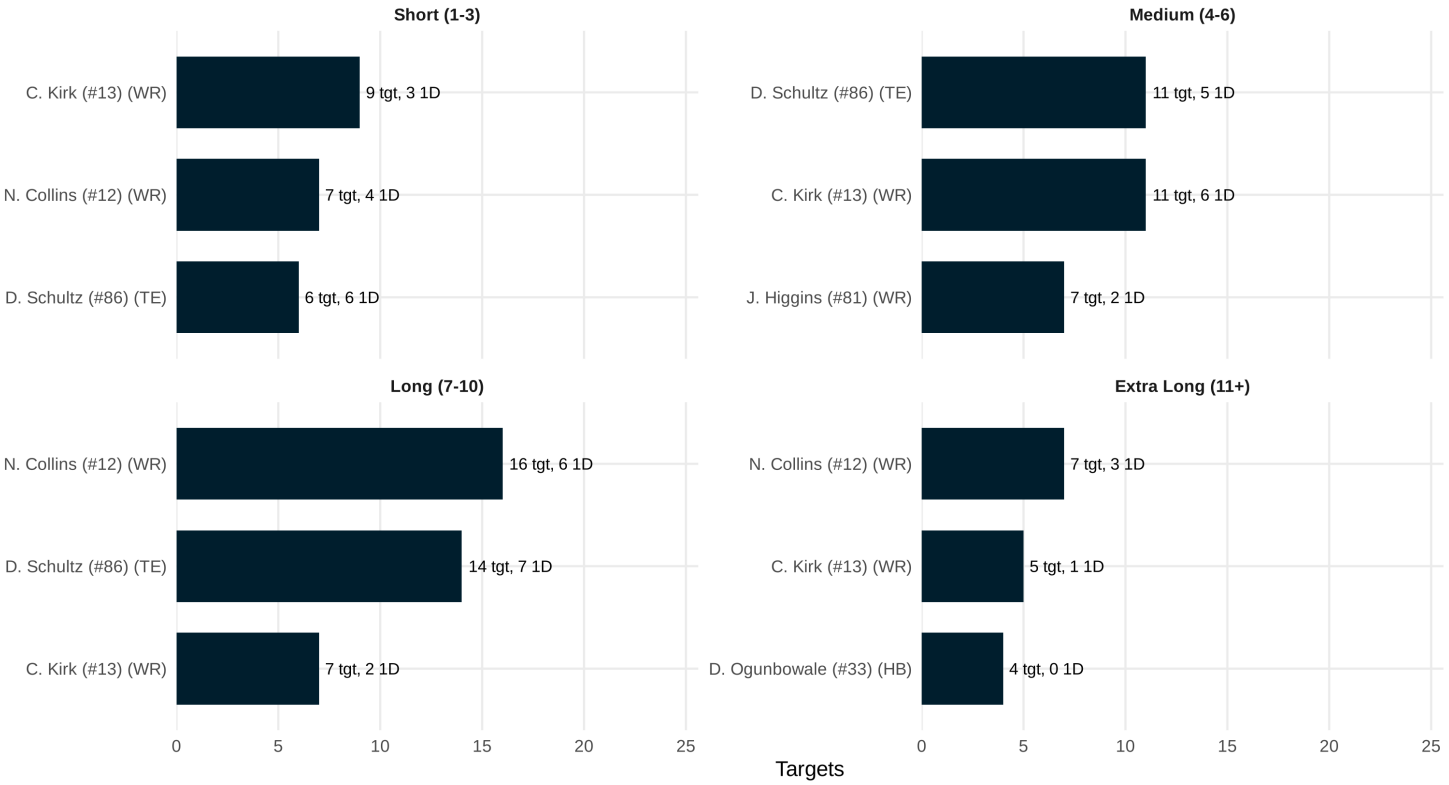
n = number of third-down plays at that distance



Data: nflverse (nflfastR pbp, NGS participation, FTN charting)

To go	Plays	Pass %	Conv %	Conv 95% CI	EPA/play	Gun/Pistol %	Avg air yds	Sack %
Short (1-3)	72	50%	65%	54%-75%	+0.10	58%	8.1	3%
Medium (4-6)	64	91%	42%	31%-54%	-0.14	94%	7.5	7%
Long (7-10)	70	99%	27%	18%-39%	+0.00	100%	8.5	7%
Extra Long (11+)	51	86%	18%	10%-30%	+0.03	100%	8.2	9%

Third-down target leaders by distance



1D = first downs gained on those targets. Data: nflverse (nflfastR pbp, NGS participation, FTN charting)

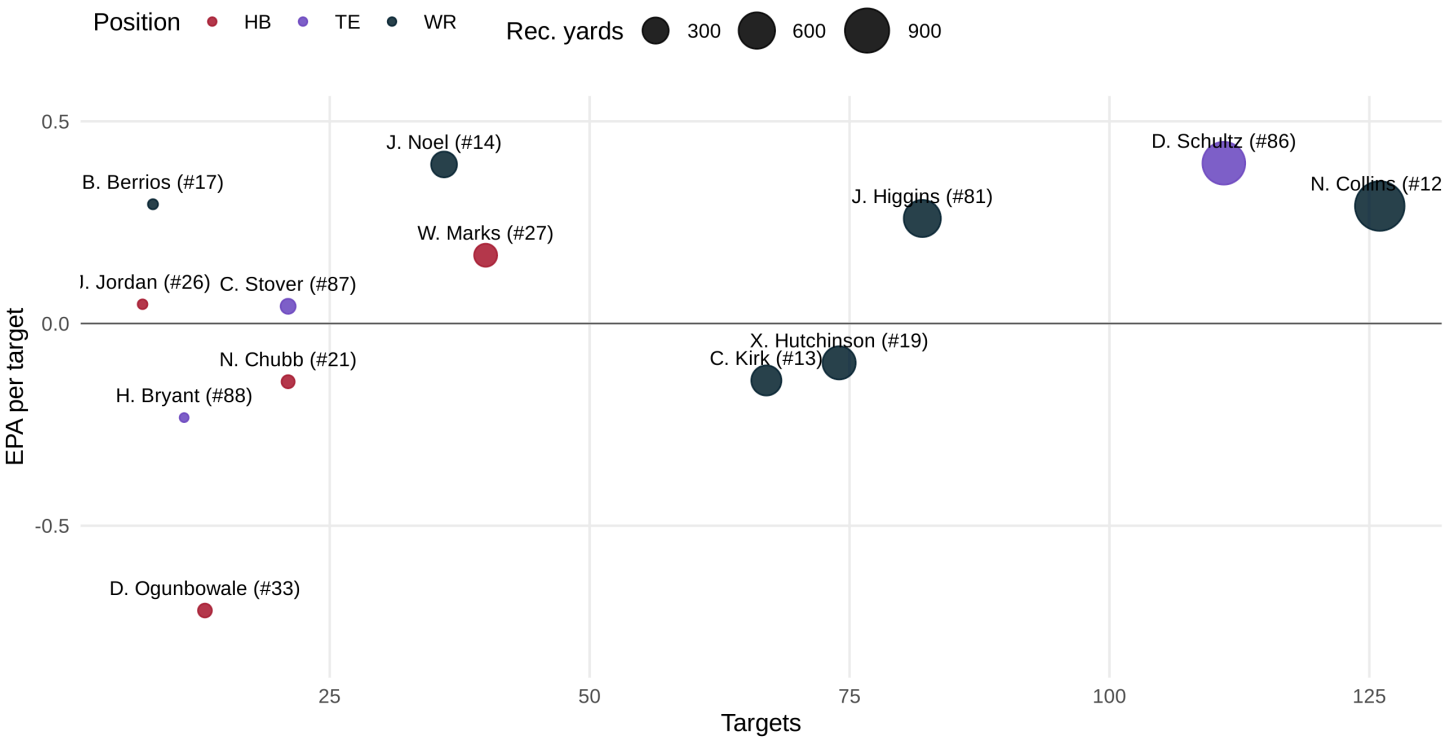
All third downs

Player	Pos	Targets	Share	Rec	Yds	1st downs	EPA/tgt	aDOT
D. Schultz (#86)	TE	35	20%	27	315	19	+0.71	6.8
C. Kirk (#13)	WR	32	19%	18	237	12	+0.07	9.6
N. Collins (#12)	WR	32	19%	19	226	14	+0.14	9.0
J. Higgins (#81)	WR	20	12%	14	221	9	+0.48	12.7
X. Hutchinson (#19)	WR	15	9%	8	92	3	-0.29	10.3
J. Noel (#14)	WR	11	6%	9	51	4	-0.09	6.0
W. Marks (#27)	HB	10	6%	6	52	4	+0.40	2.3
D. Ogunbowale (#33)	HB	9	5%	6	35	1	-0.70	1.4

6. Most effective players and how they produce

Receiving volume vs. efficiency

Players with at least 5 targets

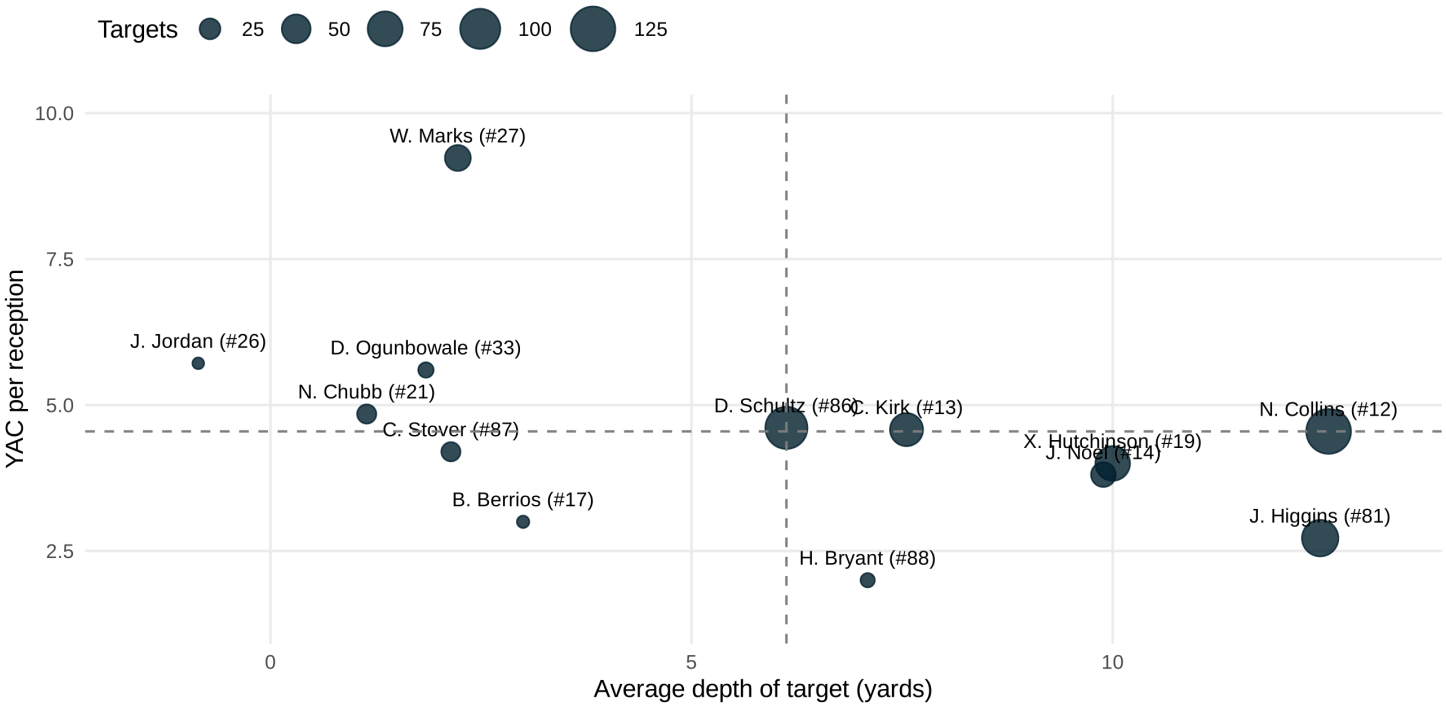


Data: nflverse (nflfastR pbp, NGS participation, FTN charting)

Player	Pos	Tgt	Share	Rec	Yds	Catch %	Y/Tgt	aDOT	YAC/Rec	EPA/Tgt	1D	Top route
N. Collins (#12)	WR	126	20%	73	1134	58%	9.0	12.6	4.5	+0.29	50	IN/DIG
D. Schultz (#86)	TE	111	18%	87	836	78%	7.5	6.1	4.6	+0.40	42	QUICK OUT
J. Higgins (#81)	WR	82	13%	50	623	61%	7.6	12.5	2.7	+0.26	33	HITCH/CURL
X. Hutchinson (#19)	WR	74	12%	41	493	55%	6.7	10.0	4.0	-0.10	22	QUICK OUT
C. Kirk (#13)	WR	67	11%	38	403	57%	6.0	7.6	4.6	-0.14	20	QUICK OUT
W. Marks (#27)	HB	40	6%	26	227	65%	5.7	2.2	9.2	+0.17	8	QUICK OUT
J. Noel (#14)	WR	36	6%	26	292	72%	8.1	9.9	3.8	+0.39	13	POST
C. Stover (#87)	TE	21	3%	15	91	71%	4.3	2.1	4.2	+0.04	4	QUICK OUT
N. Chubb (#21)	HB	21	3%	13	67	62%	3.2	1.1	4.8	-0.14	1	QUICK OUT
D. Ogunbowale (#33)	HB	13	2%	10	76	77%	5.8	1.8	5.6	-0.71	3	QUICK OUT
H. Bryant (#88)	TE	11	2%	5	28	45%	2.5	7.1	2.0	-0.23	2	QUICK OUT
B. Berrios (#17)	WR	8	1%	6	37	75%	4.6	3.0	3.0	+0.29	3	HITCH/CURL

How receivers produce: depth of target vs. yards after catch

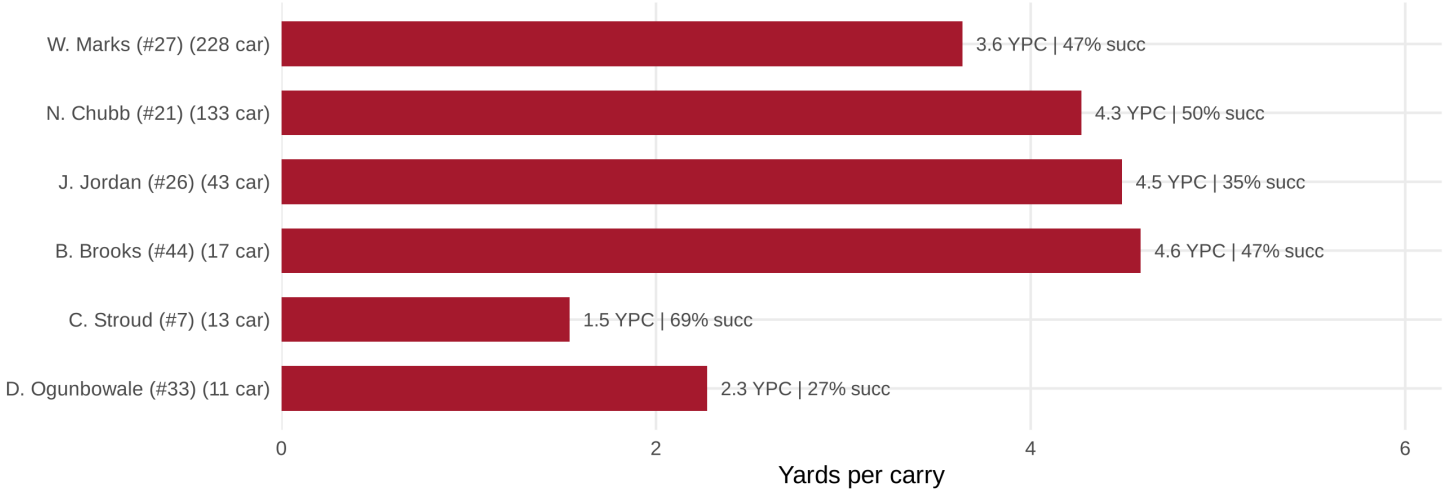
Right = targeted deeper downfield; up = more yards after the catch. Dashed = team medians



Data: nflverse (nflfastR pbp, NGS participation, FTN charting)

Rushers: yards per carry

Yards after contact is not in this data source, so carries are not split



Data: nflverse (nflfastR pbp, NGS participation, FTN charting)

Player	Carries	Share	Yds	YPC	Success	EPA/car	YBC	YACo	Explosive %	Stuff %	Top concept
W. Marks (#27)	228	49%	829	3.6	47%	-0.15	n/a	n/a	8%	23%	Middle
N. Chubb (#21)	133	28%	568	4.3	50%	-0.05	n/a	n/a	7%	14%	Middle
J. Jordan (#26)	43	9%	193	4.5	35%	-0.21	n/a	n/a	16%	23%	Middle
B. Brooks (#44)	17	4%	78	4.6	47%	+0.13	n/a	n/a	6%	24%	Middle
C. Stroud (#7)	13	3%	20	1.5	69%	+0.55	n/a	n/a	0%	23%	Middle
D. Ogunbowale (#33)	11	2%	25	2.3	27%	-0.33	n/a	n/a	0%	27%	Right Guard
C. Stover (#87)	7	1%	13	1.9	71%	-0.45	n/a	n/a	0%	29%	Middle
J. Noel (#14)	5	1%	7	1.4	20%	-0.64	n/a	n/a	0%	20%	Left End

Total offensive value (rushing + receiving EPA; QB passing EPA is credited to targets):

Player	Carries	Targets	Scrimmage yds	Rush EPA	Rec EPA	Total EPA	EPA/opp
D. Schultz (#86)	0	111	836	0.0	44.0	44.0	+0.40
N. Collins (#12)	2	126	1149	2.0	36.6	38.6	+0.30
J. Higgins (#81)	0	82	623	0.0	21.3	21.3	+0.26
J. Noel (#14)	5	36	299	-3.2	14.2	11.0	+0.27
C. Stroud (#7)	13	0	20	7.1	0.0	7.1	+0.55
B. Berrios (#17)	0	8	37	0.0	2.4	2.4	+0.29
B. Brooks (#44)	17	0	78	2.2	0.0	2.2	+0.13
J. Watson (#84)	0	4	30	0.0	1.4	1.4	+0.34

7. Passing-game context

Split	Value	Dropbacks	Share	EPA/play	Success	Y/P
Play action	No	562	78%	+0.03	42%	5.8
Play action	Yes	162	22%	+0.04	49%	6.9
Screen	No	691	95%	+0.05	45%	6.2
Screen	Yes	33	5%	-0.35	24%	3.4
Pressure	Clean	520	72%	+0.24	50%	7.4
Pressure	Pressured	204	28%	-0.50	28%	2.7

Targets by depth

Depth	Targets	Share	Comp %	Y/Tgt	EPA/Tgt	INT %
Behind LOS	81	13%	81%	4.0	-0.28	1%
Short (1-9)	334	54%	71%	5.7	+0.10	1%
Intermediate (10-19)	140	22%	52%	9.3	+0.42	4%
Deep (20+)	69	11%	36%	12.3	+0.39	6%

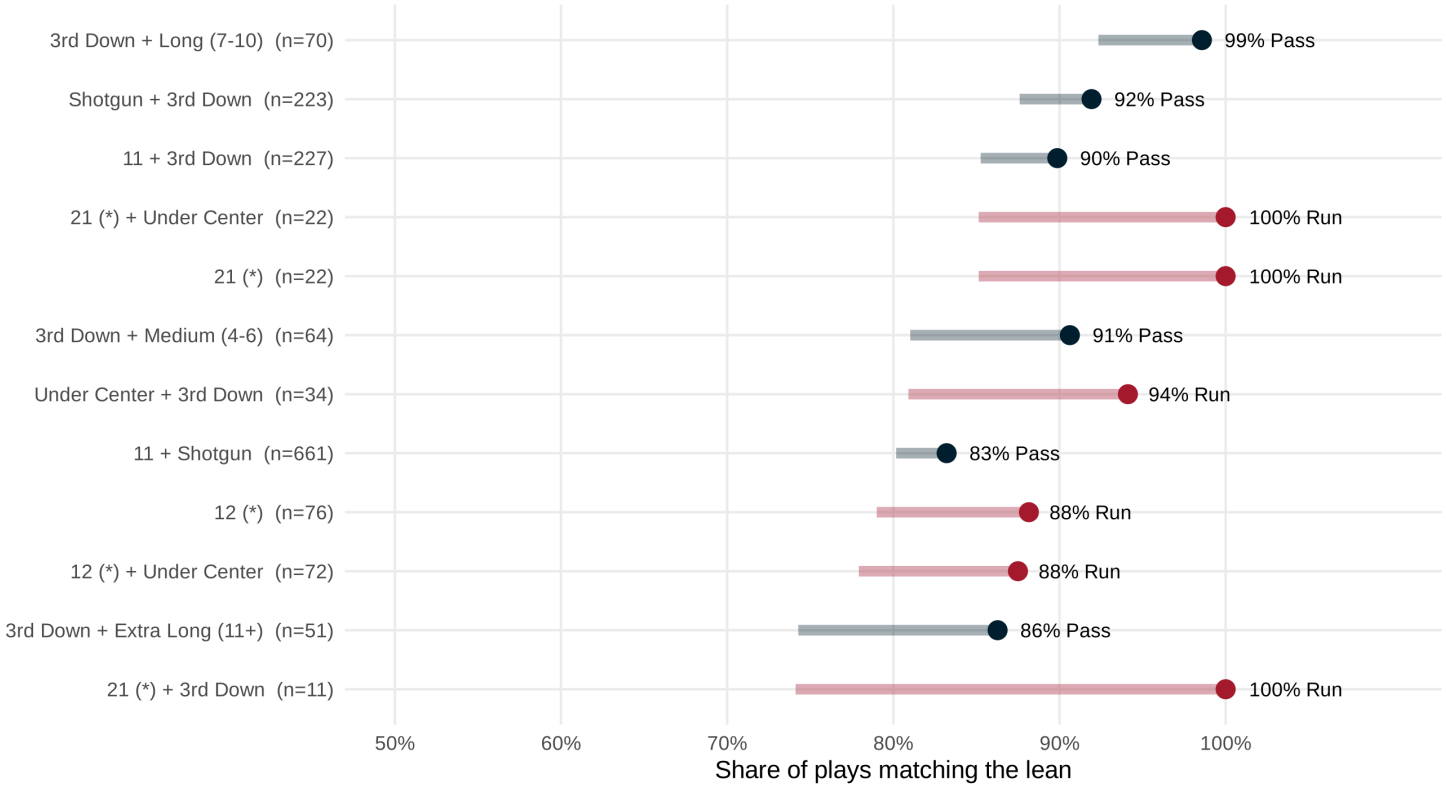
Results by defensive coverage faced (5+ dropbacks)

Coverage	Dropbacks	Share	EPA/play	Success
COVER 3	181	25%	+0.13	49%
COVER 2	180	25%	-0.08	43%
COVER 1	154	21%	+0.29	51%
COVER 4	68	9%	+0.14	37%
COVER 2 MAN	44	6%	-0.53	25%
COVER 6	40	6%	+0.21	48%
COVER 0	35	5%	-0.80	20%
COVER 9	21	3%	+0.08	48%

8. Pre-snap tells and predictability

Strongest pre-snap tells

Dot = observed rate; faded bar runs down to the 95% lower bound; n = plays with that cue



Data: nflverse (nflfastR pbp, NGS participation, FTN charting)

Always guessing the more common play type is right **61%** of the time. Using personnel, alignment, down and distance bucket (leave-one-out cell rates) is right **76%** of the time, a lift of **15%**.

Methodology and data notes

How the sample was built

Step	Plays
Offensive snaps in file	1325
Run or pass plays (drops penalties / no-plays)	1226
Downs 1-4 (drops PATs / 2-pt tries)	1226
Excluding garbage time	1203
Excluding QB kneels and spikes	1191

WHAT NFLVERSE CANNOT COVER (OR ONLY APPROXIMATES)

- Run concepts: nflverse has no blocking-scheme charting (inside zone, duo, power …). Section 4 groups runs by gap and direction instead (e.g. 'Left Tackle', 'Middle').
- PFF success codes (pff_OFFSUCCESS): not in nflverse. Success uses the standard 40/60/100 yardage rule only.
- EPA / EP: nflfastR's public model, not PFF's. Values are close in spirit but not identical.
- Yards after contact: not in nflverse, so the before/after-contact split for rushers is unavailable (yards per carry is shown instead).
- Receiver alignment (slot / wide / backfield): not in nflverse. 'Main align' is blank.
- Personnel is counted from the roster positions of the 11 players on the field (RB+FB, TE). A WR listed as TE on the roster counts as a TE. '(*)' = 6+ offensive linemen.
- Garbage time is approximated with win probability (second half, pre-snap WP below 0.01% or above 99.99%). Calibrated against a licensed PFF sample.
- 2-minute flag: inside the final 2:00 of either half (PFF's 4-minute flag has no equivalent).
- Pressure is NGS 'was_pressure' (yes/no); time to pressure is not available.

Column names below refer to the PFF GamePBP layout the nflverse data was mapped onto.

- **Pass play / dropback:** `pff_RUNPASS = "P"`, which includes sacks and QB scrambles. **Run:** `"R"`. Penalties and no-plays (`"X"`) are removed.
- **QB alignment:** Pistol if `pff_PISTOL` is set, otherwise Shotgun if `pff_SHOTGUN` is set, otherwise Under Center.
- **Success (standard):** gaining at least 40% of the distance on 1st down, 60% on 2nd, and 100% on 3rd/4th, or earning a first down. PFF success codes are not in nflverse, so only the standard rule is used.
- **First down:** `pff_FIRSTDOWNGAINED = 1` or yards gained ≥ distance.
- **EPA:** `pff_EXPECTEDPOINTSADDED` as provided. Passing EPA is attributed to the targeted receiver.
- **Target:** a pass play with a recorded receiver, excluding sacks and scrambles. **Receiving yards:** yards gained on completions.
- **Explosive:** runs of 10+ yards, passes of 20+ yards.
- **Field zone:** `ABSOLUTEYARDLINE` is yards to the opponent's end zone (so 1–20 is the red zone).
- **Tell:** a pre-snap cue (personnel, alignment, down, distance, or combinations) with at least 10 plays where one play type reaches 80%. The 95% lower bound uses a Wilson interval.
- **Intervals:** rates show 95% Wilson intervals; run-concept EPA shows ±1 standard error. With samples this small, most differences between groups are not statistically distinguishable; the report shows n everywhere so readers can judge.
- **Garbage time** excluded: TRUE. **2-minute drills** excluded: FALSE. **Personnel "(*)"** marks a jumbo package (an extra offensive lineman replaces a skill player); merged into the base grouping: FALSE.

Data checks:

- Player names from HST_2025_roster.csv (nflverse weekly rosters 2025)

Blank numeric cells (for example yards after catch on runs) are expected and listed for completeness.

Reproducibility: source file MD5 b101af0528b75031e936e1b70b8a4ed5. Every table in this report is also saved as CSV and in one Excel workbook next to this file.